Japan Trip Pre-Info Session FAQ (RAG Knowledge Base)

This document contains the FAQ items specifically collected prior to the Info Session for the Japan Trip. It is fully optimized with explicit context, synonyms, and search keywords for RAG systems.

Q: How much will the Japan Trip cost?

Keywords: Japan Trip cost, price, fee, total cost, participation fee, trip price, price estimate

Answer: We are negotiating to keep the price under $2,000 USD per person. We'll confirm the exact amount by the Info Session.

Q: How much should I budget for additional expenses during the Japan Trip?

Keywords: budget, additional expenses, pocket money, personal expenses, meal costs, local transit, flight costs, Japan Trip budget

Answer: As of Oct 11, 1-stop flights: $1,000~; Direct flights: $1,100~. Around $500 should cover basic meals and transportation between Kyoto and Osaka.

Q: Can I join late or leave early during the Japan Trip?

Keywords: join late, leave early, midway, partial participation, late arrival, early departure, schedule, Japan Trip

Answer: Yes, that's fine. However, the participation fee is the same regardless of how long you join, so we recommend attending the full Japan Trip.

Q: Can I skip the Japan Trip and join just a few events?

Keywords: skip trip, attend partial events, individual events, selected events, partial participation, Japan Trip

Answer: Unfortunately, no. To keep things fair for everyone, you'll need to pay the full Japan Trip fee even if you only attend some of the events.

Q: Will we visit specific places in Kyoto, Hiroshima, or Tokyo during the Japan Trip?

Keywords: itinerary, tourist spots, places to visit, sightseeing, travel plan, Kyoto, Hiroshima, Tokyo, Japan Trip itinerary

Answer: We'll share the full itinerary at the Info Session. You'll also have opportunities to explore on your own during optional tours and free time in Kyoto and Tokyo.

Q: Should I book my flight now for the Japan Trip?

Keywords: book flight, flight booking, waitlist, application confirmation, flight timing, Japan Trip flights

Answer: Your spot is only confirmed once applications open at the Info Session and you've paid the deposit. We recommend booking your flight after that. If you're comfortable with the risk of ending up on the waitlist, you're welcome to book earlier.

Q: When do finals end, and when does the spring quarter start?

Keywords: finals, final exams, spring quarter, academic calendar, FTMBA schedule, UCLA Anderson finals, Japan Trip timing

Answer: Core final exams run through March 18, and spring quarter instruction begins on March 29.

Q: Are there any recommended flights or arrival/departure times for the Japan Trip?

Keywords: recommended flights, arrival time, departure time, LAX flights, flight schedule, arrival date, Japan Trip flights

Answer: Since finals run through Thursday, March 18, we recommend leaving LAX on March 18 or 19 and arriving in Kyoto on Saturday, March 20. For the return trip, you can fly out of Japan on Saturday, March 27. Depending on your class schedule, you may be able to stay longer. Be careful with flights leaving LA on the afternoon of March 19, as the time difference could make your arrival too late.

Q: What is the best way to get from Los Angeles (LA) to Kyoto for the Japan Trip?

Keywords: LAX to Kyoto, travel route, KIX, Kansai Airport, Narita, Haneda, Itami, ITM, Shinkansen, ZIPAIR, transit, Japan Trip

Answer: Kansai International Airport (KIX) is the closest major international airport to Kyoto. From KIX, you can take a train or bus to Kyoto. If you can't find a suitable flight to KIX, you can fly into Tokyo (Haneda/HND or Narita/NRT) and take a domestic flight to Osaka's Itami Airport (ITM), or travel to Shinagawa and take the Shinkansen (bullet train) to Kyoto. ZIPAIR, a low-cost airline owned by Japan Airlines, may be the cheapest option, but it only flies between LAX and Narita.

Q: What time does the Japan Trip start on March 21?

Keywords: March 21, Day 1 start time, arrival time, schedule, Japan Trip start

Answer: There are no scheduled events that day. You'll just need to arrive in Japan and check into the hotel, and the rest of the day is yours.

Q: Can I join the Japan Trip on the morning of March 22?

Keywords: March 22 arrival, join morning, chartered bus, bus departure time, Japan Trip start

Answer: Our chartered bus will leave the hotel at 9:30 AM, so we recommend checking in the day before.

Q: What time does the Japan Trip end on March 27?

Keywords: March 27, Day 8 end time, departure time, check-out, Japan Trip end

Answer: There are no scheduled activities that day. You'll just check out of the hotel, so you can leave whenever works for you.

Q: Can I bring my significant other on the Japan Trip? How many guests can I bring?

Keywords: significant other, spouse, partner, bring guest, SO fee, how many guests, guest limit, Japan Trip guests

Answer: You can bring one significant other. The participation fee will be the same as for Anderson students.

Q: Can I bring a friend who is not affiliated with Anderson, or an alum on the Japan Trip?

Keywords: non-Anderson friends, alumni, outside guests, alumni participation, guest eligibility, Japan Trip

Answer: Unfortunately, no. The Japan Trip is not open to guests outside Anderson or to alumni.

Q: Can students other than first-year full-time MBAs join the Japan Trip?

Keywords: eligibility, 2nd year students, FEMBA, non-FTMBA, who can join, student eligibility, Japan Trip

Answer: Yes! The Japan Trip is open to all current Anderson students, including second-years, FEMBAs, and students in other programs.

Q: Can I request a single room or a shared room for the Japan Trip?

Keywords: single room, double room, shared room, room request, room option, private room, Hiroshima room, Japan Trip lodging

Answer: We're planning double rooms in Kyoto and Tokyo, and Japanese-style rooms shared by 4–5 people in Hiroshima. You can request a double or single room in Hiroshima, but availability is limited and there will be an additional charge.

Q: Can I choose my roommate for the Japan Trip?

Keywords: choose roommate, roommate preference, roommate assignment, partner rooming, Japan Trip rooming

Answer: You'll share a room with your significant other if they're joining. For other room assignments, we'll ask for your preferences and do our best to match you with your preferred roommates. We'll finalize the details around February.

Q: Can you accommodate vegetarian diets and food allergies during the Japan Trip?

Keywords: vegetarian, vegan, food allergies, dietary needs, dietary restrictions, meal accommodation, dietary requirements, Japan Trip meals

Answer: We expect to be able to accommodate dietary needs for meals included in the Japan Trip, with options such as no meat, no seafood, or vegetarian meals. You'll be able to list your dietary requirements in the application.

Q: Will halal meals be available during the Japan Trip?

Keywords: halal, halal meals, Muslim dietary needs, meat-free, Japan Trip food

Answer: We can arrange options such as meals without meat, but we haven't confirmed whether the meals are halal-certified. Please contact the organizing team if you need halal meals.